ACS PRF Proposal Submission Information

Before You Begin

If you have not yet registered for the PRF portal, complete registration first.

Note: For proposal submission help, contact prfsupport@acs.org

Submitting an ACS PRF Proposal by the Deadline

All DocuSign electronic signatures must be completed, and the application must be validated before submitting the proposal. The validated proposal package is submitted using the {3. Submit Application} option on the pull-down menu (Figure 1, #6). All proposals must be received in complete and final form by the deadline.

Note: No late submissions, additions, or document substitutions are allowed after the deadline.

ACS PRF Online Proposal Application Process Overview

1. Information Needed for Web Form: It is recommended that the following information is collected in a document that can be used to copy from and paste into the web form.

a. Contact Information for:

i. Principal Investigator

ii. Grant Officer and Institutional Endorsing Official (if applicable)

iii. Co-Principal Investigator (if applicable)

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Accept

Deny Non-Essential

Manage Preferences

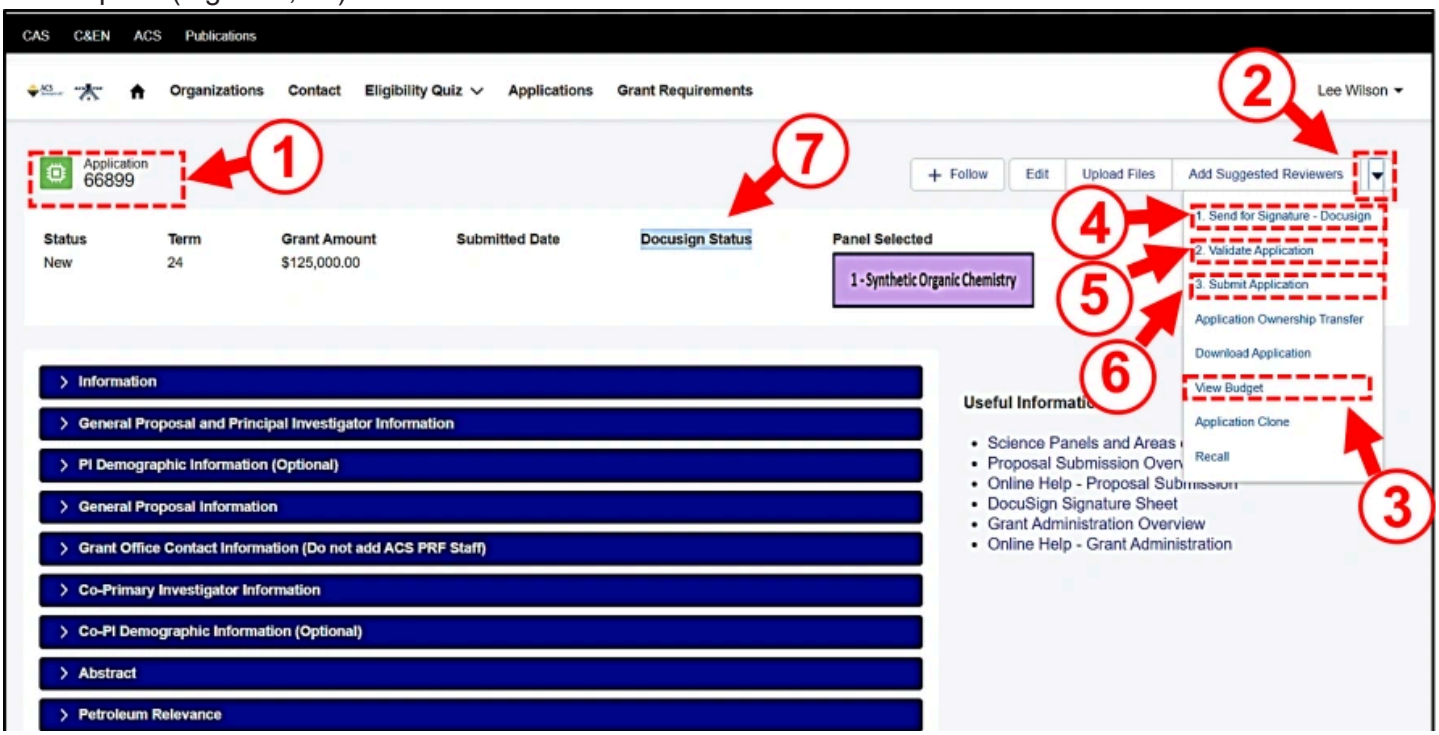
e. Requested Start Date: For proposals submitted in the February/March proposal submission window (considered at the PRF Committee Meeting of that year), January 1 of the following year isthe earliest start date. (For example, proposals submitted in February/March 2024 proposal submission window (considered at the PRF Committee Meeting in October 2024), January 1, 2025 is the earliest start date.)

f. Institutional Reference Number: If provided by your grants office. This is for your use only. Enter "NA" or "N/A" if you do not have one.

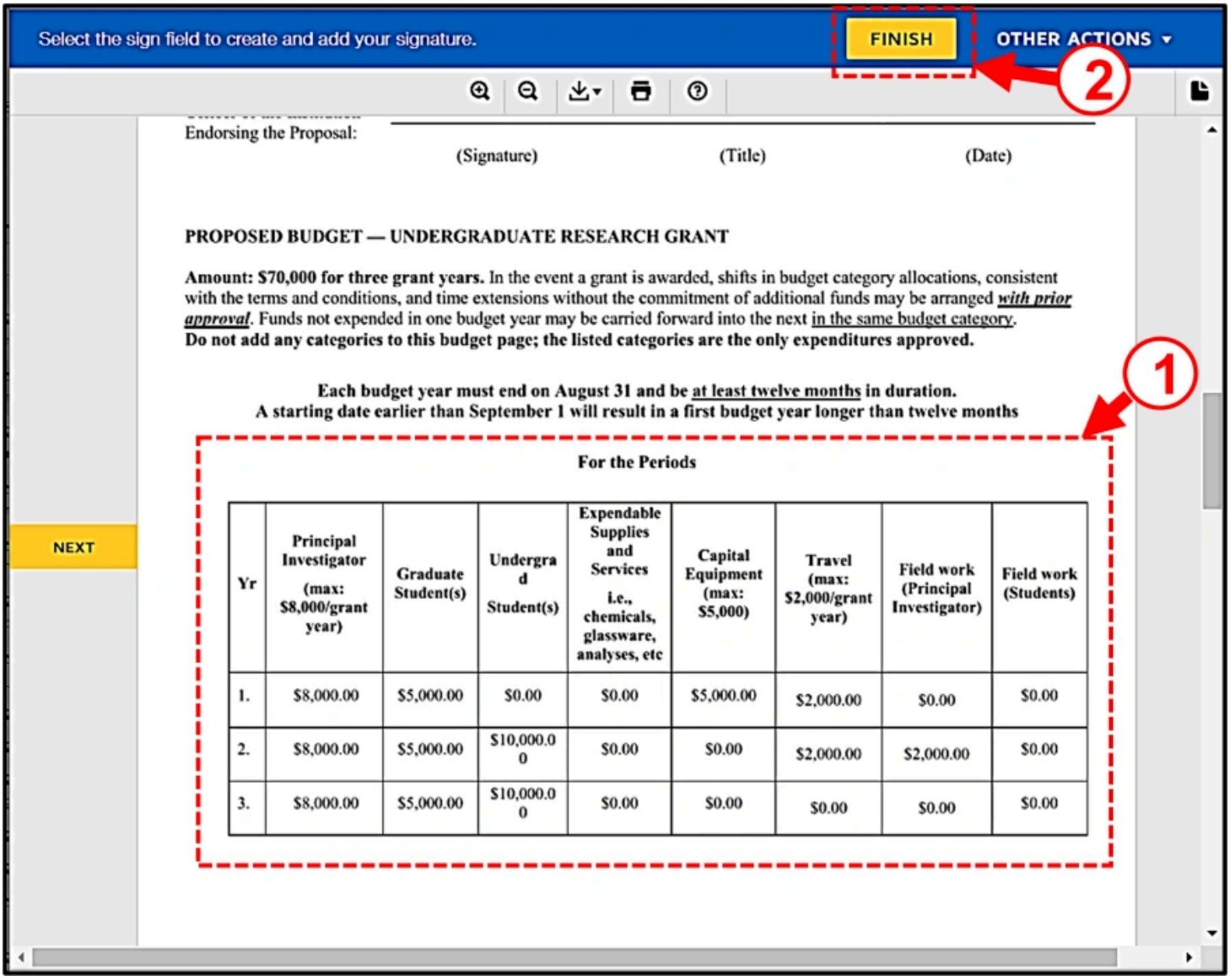
g. Resubmission (only): If a research topic was previously submitted to PRF, reviewed, and denied, a statement of modifications/changes is required.

h. Demographic Information for PI and Co-PI (incl. ORCID)

i. Budget Amount by Year and Justification: Budget years are created by clicking the [New] button on the Budget Section Header at the bottom of the application form. Amounts for approved budget categories for each grant year will be validated upon saving. Each budget period must end on August 31 and be at least twelve months in duration. A starting date earlier than September 1 will result in a first budget period (year) longer than twelve months. Fringe benefits should be included with salaries and stipends. A validated budget is included with the DocuSign Electronic Signature transmission (See Figure 1, #4). As the budget is entered, a summary of the budget can be viewed and downloaded by clicking on the {View Budget} menu option (Figure 1, #3).



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Endorsing the Proposal:

(Signature) (Title) (Date)

PROPOSED BUDGET — UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH GRANT

Amount: $70,000 for three grant years. In the event a grant is awarded, shifts in budget category allocations, consistent with the terms and conditions, and time extensions without the commitment of additional funds may be arranged ***with prior approval***. Funds not expended in one budget year may be carried forward into the next in the same budget category.
Do not add any categories to this budget page; the listed categories are the only expenditures approved.

Each budget year must end on August 31 and be at least twelve months in duration.
A starting date earlier than September 1 will result in a first budget year longer than twelve months

For the Periods

Yr	Principal Investigator (max: $8,000/grant year)	Graduate Student(s)	Undergrad Student(s)	Expendable Supplies and Services i.e., chemicals, glassware, analyses, etc	Capital Equipment (max: $5,000)	Travel (max: $2,000/grant year)	Field work (Principal Investigator)	Field work (Students)
1.	$8,000.00	$5,000.00	$0.00	$0.00	$5,000.00	$2,000.00	$0.00	$0.00
2.	$8,000.00	$5,000.00	$10,000.00	$0.00	$0.00	$2,000.00	$2,000.00	$0.00
3.	$8,000.00	$5,000.00	$10,000.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00

Figure 2. Budget Category Entry By Budget Period/Grant Year (DocuSign Signature Sheet)

j. Education and Experience: Provide information on the following for the PI and Co-PI (if applicable):

i. All academic degrees, when and where received

ii. Ph.D. thesis title and supervisor

iii. List postdoctoral appointment(s) and supervisor(s), if appropriate

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i. List any active research grants or other current financial support received for research. Give titles, amounts (annual direct costs; if more than one PI, indicate only your share of the granted amount), sources, time periods of awards, and relationship to this proposal. Indicate “none” if applicable.

ii. List any other research grant applications that are pending. Give titles, amounts requested (annual direct costs), sources, and relationship to this proposal. Indicate “none” if applicable.

iii. Describe any active start-up support or funding, including the amount and time frame. Indicate “none” if applicable.

l. Publications: List all research publications and presentations for the PI and Co-PI (if applicable). Include titles, co-authors, and literature references.

m. Safety: Principal Investigators must describe any significant risks or hazards that may be encountered in the proposed work and how these risks or hazards would be mitigated.

n. Suggested Reviewers: Names of at least six suggested reviewers are entered by clicking the [Add Suggested Reviewers] button at the top right corner of the application form (Figure 1, #2). Entered reviewers will be displayed in a separate section at the bottom of the application form. Former mentors, colleagues, and individuals from institutions with whom the PI is or has been associated are not eligible to be reviewers. Further, a PI may not suggest a reviewer whom the PI has suggested to PRF in the last 4 years.

o. Collaborations: If you will be collaborating with other scientists to perform the research described in the proposal, identify the collaborators and briefly indicate the nature of the collaboration. If any of these collaborators are current ACS PRF grantees or applicants, discuss the relationship between this proposal and the collaborator’s ACS PRF project. A letter from each collaborator confirming the extent and nature of the collaboration should be added to the application.

2. Instructions to Submit the Signature Sheet and Application:

a. Download Signature Sheet: At the top of your application, click on the inverted triangle next to the “Add Suggested Reviewers Button” and select “Download for Signatures”. A signature sheet will be generated in a new window.

b. Obtain Signatures: Print or download a copy of the signature sheet and obtain all required signatures. Note: each signatory must sign in two locations on the signature sheet. The signed signature sheet should be uploaded as a PDF.

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d. Cancel Signature: To make any modifications to the application or signature sheet, click the red "Cancel Signature" button above these instructions. The button will only be available after the signature sheet has been uploaded. Once this button is selected, edits can be made to the application or signature fields.

e. Validate and Submit Application: Select the "Validate Application" button in the drop-down menu on the inverted triangle on the top right of the screen. After validation, select the "Submit Application" button in the drop-down menu at the top right of the screen.

3. Technical Proposal: The technical proposal is uploaded as a single PDF, including the title, abstract, scientific text of the narrative, references cited, figures, and tables, using the [Upload Files] button at the top right corner of the application form. The text body may not exceed 4,000 words, double-spaced, in 12-point font (Times Roman, Arial, or Courier), with 1-inch margins, and a word count entered at the end of the proposal narrative.

Note: The word count does not include the title, 250-word abstract, figures, and references.

4. For ND Proposals: A statement (no longer than 1 page) must be included that describes how the proposed research significantly differs from the PI's previous research and represents a new research direction for the PI.

5. For UR Proposals: A statement (no longer than 1 page) must be included on prior research accomplishments and how the proposed research differs from the PI's previous research.

6. For UNI Proposals: A summary of information on (i) the highest academic degree awarded in the PI's department, (ii) available facilities, (iii) teaching duties, (iv) percentage of time devoted to research, and (v) percentage of time devoted to research during the summer is required.

7. For UNI and UR Proposals: A statement (no longer than 1 page) must be included that briefly describes how the PI's mentoring of students will impact scientific education at their institution and department.

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